

■ How do you get a brand-new monitor to display an image that's as perfect as possible? The answer is to calibrate and characterise the monitor. Calibration removes colour casts, and sets a known white point on your monitor as a reference point for variation in brightness and contrast; and characterisation creates a monitor profile for use with a colour profile.

- Specialised software are available for calibrating monitors. For PCs running Windows, a commonly used program is Adobe Gamma, which comes bundled with most Adobe products.

■ To calibrate your monitor, go to **Start > Run > Control Panel > Adobe Gamma**. Select the 'Step by Step' wizard. It will prompt you to give a unique profile name. Next, it will prompt you to adjust the brightness and contrast so that the centre box is as dark as possible. It will then display the phosphor that your monitor displays.

- Adjust your gamma setting and set the hardware white point according to your preferences. Save your profile. The next time you boot your machine, the same profile will apply.

A dual monitor set-up can be a boon for graphic designers and video or image editors, or for those who work with office applications most of the time. Imagine working on a video- or image-editing application with multiple images open. A dual monitor set-up allows you to reduce the stress and make the whole experience more fun. By enabling an extended desktop, you can easily space out the whole application across two monitors.

Another area is office applications. Working with different types of office applications like Word, Excel, Outlook and so on all at the same time can get cumbersome. The number of times a user has to task-switch between applications is simply mind-boggling. Here too, a dual display comes to the rescue. You can drag and drop applications of your choice in either of the monitors and work at ease. For example, let's say you like to keep Outlook open all the time to check



e-mail as soon as they arrive. But naturally that's not the only application you'll be keeping open. A dual-monitor solution allows you to avoid clutter—you can place Outlook on the secondary monitor while you complete your tasks on the main monitor.

Here's how you can get your dual monitor up and running in no time. Place the monitors side by side. Install the graphics card in the system and connect the D-Sub cables from the two monitors to it. If your card features a DVI port instead of an extra D-Sub port, use a DVI to D-Sub adapter. Switch on the system. Your second monitor should get detected. Install the proper drivers for the second monitor and open display properties.

Now select the second monitor and click on 'Extend my windows desktop on to this monitor'. Click on Identify and check if your selection of primary and secondary is proper. And that's it—you're set!

Space has become a major cause of worry for the corporate segment. Even home users would like to have that extra space on their desks. And so, many people are turning to LCD displays.

CRTs have, over a period, tried hard to stay in the competition by offering flat tubes instead of the curved tubes characteristic of low-end monitors, and adding anti-glare glass to monitor. Some new monitors even have a dedicated button to set the display for normal, gaming or cinema mode, where the monitor adjust the best brightness and contrast for that particular mode.

LCD screens, on the other hand, are gaining wide acceptance in the market—data centres, banks and call centres are some of the main buyers of LCD monitors. Banks and

financial institutions tend to buy big-sized LCD displays as well.

So what's the new display technology taking shape in labs around the world? Plasma display is one technique that's been around for some time but this hasn't really made a mark because of the very high costs involved. Plasma displays are toys of the rich and famous and they'll continue to be that way for sometime. They are better for home theatres than for business purposes.

CDT Ltd, a UK-based company that licenses its patents and technologies to other companies, is developing a polymer organic light-emitting diode (OLED) display technology. Once this technology is implemented,